Text 1

新习惯与创造性思维

第 1 段

Habits are a funny thing. We reach for them mindlessly, setting our brains on auto-pilot and relaxing into the unconscious comfort of familiar routine. “Not choice, but habit rules the unreflecting herd,” William Wordsworth said in the 19th century. In the ever-changing 21st century, even the word “habit” carries a negative implication.

习惯是个奇妙的东西。我们不假思索地依赖习惯，让大脑进入自动驾驶状态，放松地沉浸在熟悉常规所带来的无意识的舒适之中。威廉·华兹华斯在 19 世纪说：‘支配不加思考的大众的，不是选择，而是习惯。’在不断变化的 21 世纪，就连‘习惯’这个词也带有负面的意味。

第 2 段

So it seems paradoxical to talk about habits in the same context as creativity and innovation. But brain researchers have discovered that when we consciously develop new habits, we create parallel paths, and even entirely new brain cells, that can jump our trains of thought onto new, innovative tracks.

因此，把习惯与创造力和创新放在同一语境中讨论，似乎自相矛盾。但大脑研究人员发现，当我们有意识地培养新习惯时，我们就会建立平行的通路，甚至产生全新的脑细胞；它们能够让我们的思路跃上新的、富有创新性的轨道。

第 3 段

Rather than dismissing ourselves as unchangeable creatures of habit, we can instead direct our own change by consciously developing new habits. In fact, the more new things we try — the more we step outside our comfort zone — the more inherently creative we become, both in the workplace and in our personal lives.

我们不必把自己认定为无法改变的习惯动物，而可以通过有意识地培养新习惯来引导自身的变化。事实上，我们尝试的新事物越多 —— 越走出自己的舒适区 —— 无论在工作中还是在个人生活中，我们本身就越有创造力。

第 4 段

But don’t bother trying to kill off old habits; once those ruts of procedure are worn into the brain, they’re there to stay. Instead, the new habits we deliberately press into ourselves create parallel pathways that can bypass those old roads.

但不必费力试图消除旧习惯；那些程式化的思维车辙一旦在大脑中形成，就会一直留在那里。相反，我们刻意养成的新习惯会建立平行的通路，使我们能够绕开那些旧路。

第 5 段

“The first thing needed for innovation is a fascination with wonder,” says Dawna Markova, author of The Open Mind. “But we are taught instead to ‘decide’ , just as our president calls himself ‘the Decider’. ” She adds, however, that “to decide is to kill off all possibilities but one. A good innovational thinker is always exploring the many other possibilities.”

《开放的心智》作者道娜 · 马尔科娃说：‘ 创新首先需要的是对未知奥妙的强烈好奇。可是，我们受到的教育却是去 “ 做决定 ”，就像我们的总统称自己为 “ 决策者 ” 一样。’ 不过，她补充说：‘ 做决定，就是只留下一个可能性，排除所有其他可能性。善于创新思考的人总是在探索许多其他可能性。’

第 6 段

All of us work through problems in ways of which we’re unaware, she says. Researchers in the late 1960s discovered that humans are born with the capacity to approach challenges in four primary ways: analytically, procedurally, relationally (or collaboratively) and innovatively. At the end of adolescence, however, the brain shuts down half of that capacity, preserving only those modes of thought that have seemed most valuable during the first decade or so of life.

她说，我们所有人都以自己没有意识到的方式解决问题。20 世纪 60 年代末，研究人员发现，人类天生具备用四种基本方式应对挑战的能力：分析式、程序式、关系式（或协作式）以及创新式。然而，在青春期结束时，大脑会关闭其中一半的能力，仅保留那些在生命最初十来年中似乎最有价值的思维方式。

第 7 段

The current emphasis on standardized testing highlights analysis and procedure, meaning that few of us inherently use our innovative and collaborative modes of thought. “This breaks the major rule in the American belief system — that anyone can do anything,” explains M. J. Ryan, author of the 2006 book This Year I Will... and Ms. Markova’s business partner. “That’s a lie that we have perpetuated, and it fosters commonness. Knowing what you’re good at and doing even more of it creates excellence.” This is where developing new habits comes in.

当前对标准化考试的重视突出强调分析和程序，这意味着我们中很少有人会自然而然地运用创新和协作的思维方式。2006 年出版的《今年我将……》的作者、马尔科娃的商业伙伴 M. J. 瑞安解释说：‘ 这违背了美国信念体系中的主要原则 —— 任何人都能做任何事情。那是一个我们一直延续的谎言，它滋生平庸。知道自己擅长什么，并更多地去做，才能造就卓越。’ 这正是培养新习惯发挥作用的地方。

阅读分析

文章先提出 ‘ 习惯似乎妨碍创新 ’ 的表面矛盾，再说明有意识地培养新习惯能拓展思维通路，最后讨论教育对思维方式的筛选和新习惯的作用。

直译提示

第 3 段 the more ... the more ... 表示 ‘ 越……，就越……’；第 6 段 ways of which we’re unaware 中 of which 与 be unaware of 对应，不能把它当作原因从句。

Text 2

商业 DNA 检测的局限

第 1 段

It is a wise father that knows his own child, but today a man can boost his paternal (fatherly) wisdom — or at least confirm that he's the kid's dad. All he needs to do is shell out $30 for a paternity testing kit (PTK) at his local drugstore — and another $120 to get the results.

能认清自己孩子的父亲才算明智，但如今，一个男人可以增进自己作为父亲的这种智慧 —— 或者至少确认自己就是孩子的父亲。他只需在当地药店花 30 美元买一套亲子鉴定试剂盒（PTK），再花 120 美元获得检测结果。

第 2 段

More than 60,000 people have purchased the PTKs since they first became available without prescriptions last year, according to Doug Fogg, chief operating officer of Identigene, which makes the over-the-counter kits. More than two dozen companies sell DNA tests directly to the public, ranging in price from a few hundred dollars to more than $2,500.

生产这类非处方试剂盒的 Identigene 公司的首席运营官道格 · 福格说，自去年这些试剂盒无需处方即可购买以来，已有六万多人买过。超过二十四家公司直接向公众销售 DNA 检测服务，价格从几百美元到 2500 多美元不等。

第 3 段

Among the most popular: paternity and kinship testing, which adopted children can use to find their biological relatives and families can use to track down kids put up for adoption. DNA testing is also the latest rage among passionate genealogists — and supports businesses that offer to search for a family's geographic roots.

最受欢迎的项目包括亲子关系和亲缘关系检测；被收养的孩子可以借此找到自己的血缘亲属，家庭也可以借此寻找曾被送去收养的孩子。DNA 检测还是热衷家谱研究的人们之间最新的时尚，并支撑起了提供家族地理起源查询服务的生意。

第 4 段

Most tests require collecting cells by swabbing saliva in the mouth and sending it to the company for testing. All tests require a potential candidate with whom to compare DNA.

大多数检测要求用拭子采集口腔中的唾液以获取细胞，再将样本寄给公司检测。所有检测都需要找到一个可能有关联的对象，用其 DNA 进行比较。

第 5 段

But some observers are skeptical. “There’s a kind of false precision being hawked by people claiming they are doing ancestry testing,” says Troy Duster, a New York University sociologist. He notes that each individual has many ancestors — numbering in the hundreds just a few centuries back. Yet most ancestry testing only considers a single lineage, either the Y chromosome inherited through men in a father’s line or mitochondrial DNA, which is passed down only from mothers. This DNA can reveal genetic information about only one or two ancestors, even though, for example, just three generations back people also have six other great-grandparents or, four generations back, 14 other great-great-grandparents.

但一些观察者持怀疑态度。纽约大学社会学家特洛伊·达斯特说：‘那些声称在做祖先检测的人，正在兜售一种虚假的精确性。’他指出，每个人都有许多祖先 —— 只往前追溯几个世纪，人数就能达到数百。然而，大多数祖先检测只考虑一条谱系：要么是沿父系由男性传递的 Y 染色体，要么是只由母亲传下来的线粒体 DNA。这种 DNA 只能揭示一两位祖先的遗传信息，尽管例如仅往前追溯三代，人们就还有另外六位曾祖辈祖先，或往前追溯四代，就还有另外十四位高祖辈祖先。

第 6 段

Critics also argue that commercial genetic testing is only as good as the reference collections to which a sample is compared. Databases used by some companies don’t rely on data collected systematically but rather lump together information from different research projects. This means that a DNA database may have a lot of data from some regions and not others, so a person’s test results may differ depending on the company that processes the results. In addition, the computer programs a company uses to estimate relationships may be patented and not subject to peer review or outside evaluation.

批评者还认为，商业基因检测的可靠程度，取决于用来与样本进行比较的参考资料库的质量。有些公司使用的数据库并不依靠系统采集的数据，而是把来自不同研究项目的信息拼凑在一起。这意味着，一个 DNA 数据库可能拥有某些地区的大量数据，却没有其他地区的相应数据；因此，一个人的检测结果可能因处理结果的公司不同而不同。此外，公司用来估算亲缘关系的计算机程序可能受到专利保护，不接受同行评审或外部评估。

阅读分析

前半部分说明直接面向消费者的 DNA 检测迅速普及，后半部分指出谱系覆盖有限、参考数据库失衡以及算法缺少外部审查等问题。不能把‘有检测结果’等同于‘结果全面可靠’。

直译提示

第 1 句 It is a wise father that knows his own child 是带有警示意味的谚语表达，强调确认血缘并非易事；第 6 段 only as good as ... 表示可靠性受比较资料质量限制。

Text 3

教育、生产率与经济增长

第 1 段

The relationship between formal education and economic growth in poor countries is widely misunderstood by economists and politicians alike. Progress in both areas is undoubtedly necessary for the social, political, and intellectual development of these and all other societies; however, the conventional view that education should be one of the very highest priorities for promoting rapid economic development in poor countries is wrong. We are fortunate that it is, because building new educational systems there and putting enough people through them to improve economic performance would require two or three generations. The findings of a research institution have consistently shown that workers in all countries can be trained on the job to achieve radically higher productivity and, as a result, radically higher standards of living.

经济学家和政治家普遍误解了贫穷国家中正规教育与经济增长之间的关系。这两个领域的进步，无疑是这些社会以及所有其他社会实现社会、政治和智力发展的必要条件；然而，认为教育应当成为促进贫穷国家经济快速发展的最优先事项之一，这种传统看法是错误的。幸好它是错误的，因为在那里建立新的教育体系，并让足够多的人接受教育以改善经济表现，需要两三代人的时间。一家研究机构的研究结果一直表明，所有国家的工人都可以通过在职培训大幅提高生产率，并由此大幅提高生活水平。

第 2 段

Ironically, the first evidence for this idea appeared in the United States. Not long ago, with the country entering a recession and Japan at its pre-bubble peak, the U.S. workforce was derided as poorly educated and one of the primary causes of the poor U.S. economic performance. Japan was, and remains, the global leader in automotive-assembly productivity. Yet the research revealed that the U.S. factories of Honda, Nissan, and Toyota achieved about 95 percent of the productivity of their Japanese counterparts — a result of the training that U.S. workers received on the job.

颇具讽刺意味的是，支持这一观点的最早证据出现在美国。不久前，当美国进入经济衰退而日本处于泡沫破裂前的高峰时，美国劳动力被讥讽为教育水平低下，并被认为是美国经济表现不佳的主要原因之一。日本过去是、现在仍然是汽车装配生产率方面的全球领先者。然而，研究显示，本田、日产和丰田在美国的工厂，其生产率达到了日本同类工厂的约 95%—— 这是美国工人接受在职培训的结果。

第 3 段

More recently, while examining housing construction, the researchers discovered that illiterate, non-English-speaking Mexican workers in Houston, Texas, consistently met best-practice labor productivity standards despite the complexity of the building industry's work.

更近一些时候，在考察住宅建筑业时，研究人员发现，尽管建筑行业的工作十分复杂，得克萨斯州休斯敦那些不识字、不会说英语的墨西哥工人，仍能持续达到最佳实践所对应的劳动生产率标准。

第 4 段

What is the real relationship between education and economic development? We have to suspect that continuing economic growth promotes the development of education even when governments don't force it. After all, that's how education got started. When our ancestors were hunters and gatherers 10,000 years ago, they didn't have time to wonder much about anything besides finding food. Only when humanity began to get its food in a more productive way was there time for other things.

教育与经济发展之间真正的关系是什么？我们有理由猜想，即使政府不强力推动，持续的经济增长也会促进教育发展。毕竟，教育就是这样开始的。一万年前，当我们的祖先还是狩猎者和采集者时，除了寻找食物，他们没有多少时间思考别的事情。只有当人类开始以更高效的方式获取食物时，才有时间做其他事情。

第 5 段

As education improved, humanity's productivity potential increased as well. When the competitive environment pushed our ancestors to achieve that potential, they could in turn afford more education. This increasingly high level of education is probably a necessary, but not a sufficient, condition for the complex political systems required by advanced economic performance. Thus poor countries might not be able to escape their poverty traps without political changes that may be possible only with broader formal education. A lack of formal education, however, doesn't constrain the ability of the developing world's workforce to substantially improve productivity for the foreseeable future. On the contrary, constraints on improving productivity explain why education isn't developing more quickly there than it is.

随着教育改善，人类的生产率潜力也提高了。当竞争环境迫使我们的祖先实现这种潜力时，他们反过来就有能力负担更多教育。对于高水平经济表现所需要的复杂政治制度而言，这种不断提高的教育水平，很可能是必要条件，却不是充分条件。因此，如果没有可能只有通过更广泛的正规教育才能实现的政治变革，贫穷国家也许无法摆脱贫困陷阱。然而，正规教育的不足，并不会限制发展中世界的劳动力在可预见的将来大幅提高生产率的能力。相反，对生产率提高的限制，解释了为什么那里的教育没有比现在发展得更快。

阅读分析

作者反对把扩大正规教育当作短期提高生产率的先决条件；在职培训的例子支持这一点。文章同时承认教育对复杂政治制度的重要性，并讨论经济增长反过来促进教育。

直译提示

第 1 段 We are fortunate that it is 中 is 省略了 wrong；末段必要条件不等于充分条件，不能把作者的主张简化为 ‘ 教育没有用 ’。

Text 4

新英格兰的知识精英与普通移民

第 1 段

The most thoroughly studied intellectuals in the history of the New World are the ministers and political leaders of seventeenth-century New England. According to the standard history of American philosophy, nowhere else in colonial America was "so much importance attached to intellectual pursuits." According to many books and articles, New England's leaders established the basic themes and preoccupations of an unfolding, dominant Puritan tradition in American intellectual life.

在新大陆历史中，受到最彻底研究的知识分子，是 17 世纪新英格兰的牧师和政治领袖。根据美国哲学史的标准叙述，在殖民地时期的美洲，没有其他地方像这里一样 ' 如此重视智识追求 '。根据许多著作和文章，新英格兰的领袖确立了美国思想生活中一种正在展开并占据主导地位的清教传统的基本主题和核心关注。

第 2 段

To take this approach to the New Englanders normally means to start with the Puritans' theological innovations and their distinctive ideas about the church — important subjects that we may not neglect. But in keeping with our examination of southern intellectual life, we may consider the original Puritans as carriers of European culture, adjusting to New World circumstances. The New England colonies were the scenes of important episodes in the pursuit of widely understood ideals of civility and virtuosity.

以这种方式研究新英格兰人，通常意味着从清教徒的神学创新以及他们对教会的独特观念入手 —— 这些都是我们不可忽视的重要课题。但是，与我们对南方思想生活的考察保持一致，我们可以把最初的清教徒看成欧洲文化的携带者，他们在适应新大陆的环境。新英格兰各殖民地是一些重要历史事件发生的场所；这些事件体现了人们对当时广为理解的文明礼仪与博雅修养理想的追求。

第 3 段

The early settlers of Massachusetts Bay included men of impressive education and influence in England. Besides the ninety or so learned ministers who came to Massachusetts churches in the decade after 1629, there were political leaders like John Winthrop, an educated gentleman, lawyer, and official of the Crown before he journeyed to Boston. These men wrote and published extensively, reaching both New World and Old World audiences, and giving New England an atmosphere of intellectual earnestness.

马萨诸塞湾的早期定居者中，有些人在英国就受过令人瞩目的教育并具有影响力。除了 1629 年之后十年间来到马萨诸塞教会的约九十名博学牧师外，还有约翰 · 温思罗普这样的政治领袖；在前往波士顿之前，他是一位受过教育的绅士、律师和王室官员。这些人写作和出版甚多，读者遍及新大陆与旧大陆，并为新英格兰营造了一种认真从事学术与思想活动的氛围。

第 4 段

We should not forget, however, that most New Englanders were less well educated. While few craftsmen or farmers, let alone dependents and servants, left literary compositions to be analyzed, it is obvious that their views were less fully intellectualized. Their thinking often had a traditional superstitious quality. A tailor named John Dane, who emigrated in the late 1630s, left an account of his reasons for leaving England that is filled with signs. Sexual confusion, economic frustrations, and religious hope — all came together in a decisive moment when he opened the Bible, told his father that the first line he saw would settle his fate, and read the magical words: "Come out from among them, touch no unclean thing, and I will be your God and you shall be my people." One wonders what Dane thought of the careful sermons explaining the Bible that he heard in Puritan churches.

然而，我们不应忘记，大多数新英格兰人的受教育程度没有那么高。虽然很少有工匠或农民留下可供分析的文字作品，更不用说受人供养者和仆人，但可以清楚看出，他们的观念并没有经过那么充分的理性整理。他们的思想往往带有传统迷信的色彩。一位名叫约翰·戴恩的裁缝在 17 世纪 30 年代末移民，他留下了一份讲述自己为何离开英国的记录，其中充满了被他视为征兆的事情。性方面的困惑、经济上的挫折以及宗教上的希望，都汇聚在一个决定性时刻：他打开《圣经》，告诉父亲自己看见的第一行将决定自己的命运，然后读到了这些神奇的话：‘你们要从他们中间出来，不要沾不洁净的东西，我就要作你们的神，你们要作我的子民。’人们不禁想知道，对于他在清教教堂里听到的那些细致解释《圣经》的布道，戴恩会作何感想。

第 5 段

Meanwhile, many settlers had slighter religious commitments than Dane's, as one clergyman learned in confronting folk along the coast who mocked that they had not come to the New World for religion. "Our main end was to catch fish."

与此同时，许多定居者对宗教的投入比戴恩更少。一位牧师在与沿海居民打交道时就发现了这一点：这些人嘲笑说，他们来到新大陆并不是为了宗教。‘我们的主要目的就是捕鱼。’

阅读分析

文章先介绍以牧师和政治领袖为中心的传统研究，再转向普通移民，指出他们的思想常带有迷信色彩，宗教动机也不一致，不能以精英的思想概括所有居民。

直译提示

第 4 段 While few ... left ... 是让步关系；第 5 段 end 表示‘目的’，结尾捕鱼的引语用来反驳把所有移民都理解为虔诚宗教追随者的概括。